Architectural Evolution of the Stela Platform: Tasks, Agents, and Project Mechanics

Executive Summary

The Stela platform stands at a critical juncture in its evolution, transitioning from a phase of capability acquisition to one of rigorous operational hardening. The current architecture, defined by the interplay between human authority and artificial intelligence logic, relies on a "Stateless" philosophy where context is explicitly loaded rather than implicitly assumed. This report provides a comprehensive analysis of the "Phase Two" (Tasks) and "Phase Three" (Agents) expansion, culminating in the "Phase Four" (Project Mechanics) consolidation.

The primary objective of this analysis is to define the architectural specifications for the implementation of the Tasks Subsystem (DP-OPS-0016), the Agents Subsystem (DP-OPS-0017), and the Project Mechanics consolidation (DP-OPS-0018). Central to this evolution is the formalization of the "Task Registry," the refactoring of legacy "B-TASK" artifacts into hardened Stela Canon, and the strict enforcement of the "Staffing Protocol" between the Operator, Integrator, and Contractor.

The analysis reveals that while the platform's constitution (TRUTH.md) and history ledger (SoP.md) are robust, the operational layer suffers from "Drift"—specifically, the existence of generic task definitions that lack provenance and the use of a monolithic TASK.md interface that encourages context pollution. The proposed solution involves a radical refactoring of the Task and Agent libraries, enforcing a "Pointer-First" constitution where files are referenced by path to ensure a Single Source of Truth (SSOT). This report details the specific implementation requirements for these subsystems, adhering to the user's explicit override to retain the B-TASK nomenclature while upgrading the underlying "genome" of the files to match the rigorous T-OPS standards proposed in initial design documents.

I. The Stela Constitutional Framework and Operational Ontology

The foundation of the Stela platform is not merely code, but a rigid governance structure that defines the relationship between human intent and machine execution. This structure is codified in TRUTH.md and AGENTS.md, which serve as the immutable constitution of the system.[1] Understanding this framework is prerequisite to analyzing the Tasks and Agents subsystems.

1.1 The Philosophy of Stateless Operations

Stela operates on a "Stateless" paradigm. Unlike traditional systems that rely on persistent memory or implicit knowledge, Stela assumes that "Context is not memory; it is a file".[1] This philosophy dictates that for an agent to be operationally aware, it must be "rehydrated" via a specific set of artifacts listed in ops/lib/manifests/CONTEXT.md. If an artifact is not explicitly loaded, it does not exist for the purpose of the current session.

This approach mitigates "Hallucination" and "Drift" by grounding every action in a verifiable file on disk. The "Open Prompt" (ops/bin/open) and the "State Capture" (ops/bin/dump) are the mechanical implementations of this philosophy, creating a closed loop where the system state is serialized before work begins and verified after work completes.[1]

1.2 The Staffing Protocol and Jurisdictional Logic

The "Staffing Protocol," defined in AGENTS.md, establishes a hierarchy of authority that prevents the AI from overstepping its bounds. This protocol divides the labor into three distinct roles:

Role	Entity	Jurisdiction	Responsibilities
Operator	Human	Final Authority	Owns decisions, approvals, and secrets. Performs all git commits, pushes, and merges.
Integrator	Lead AI	Governance	Maintains structural integrity, detects drift, and generates Dispatch Packets (DPs).
Contractor	Guest AI	Execution	Executes logic tasks and drafts implementation details within a defined scope.

This separation of concerns is critical for the Tasks Subsystem. The **Integrator** is responsible for selecting the Task from the Registry and defining the Scope in TASK.md. The **Contractor**

is responsible for executing the Task and producing the "Receipt." The distinction ensures that the entity defining the work is not the same as the entity performing the work, introducing a necessary layer of auditability.[1]

1.3 Behavioral Logic and Linguistic Precision

To ensure that the interaction between these roles is precise, AGENTS.md enforces a "Behavioral Logic Standard." A key component of this is "Linguistic Precision," specifically the "Contraction Prohibition".[1] Agents are forbidden from using contractions (e.g., "don't," "can't"). While this may seem stylistic, it serves a functional purpose: it forces a rhythmic precision that aids in technical auditing and reduces the probability of ambiguity in Large Language Model (LLM) outputs. By forcing the agent to write "do not" instead of "don't," the system subtly enforces a formal, logical stance that correlates with higher-quality code generation.

Furthermore, the standard mandates "Quantitative Reporting" and "Absolute Literalism." Agents must report deviations in exact percentages or file counts, avoiding subjective descriptions like "some files were changed." This rigorous standard must be applied to the refactoring of the B-TASK files in DP-OPS-0016, transforming them from loose checklists into quantitative algorithms.[1]

II. The Tasks Subsystem (Phase Two Implementation)

The "Tasks Subsystem" represents the operational engine of Stela. A "Task" is defined as the "routine" or execution logic that applies "Skills" (tools) to "Projects" (payloads). The current state of the repository reveals a subsystem in transition, burdened by legacy artifacts and a loose interface.

2.1 Analysis of Current State and Drift

The repository dump indicates the presence of six task files: B-TASK-01 through B-TASK-06.[1] However, the design analysis describes these as "generic" artifacts that lack the "Stela Canon" genome. They are likely simple checklists imported from an external context, lacking the specific "Provenance," "Scope," and "Drift Preventer" sections required by the platform's constitution.

The primary vector of "Drift" in the current system is the monolithic nature of TASK.md. Currently, TASK.md functions as both the interface and the definition for some routines. This violates the "Interface/Implementation Separation" principle. Loading thousands of tokens of task definitions into the context window for every session ("Context Pollution") degrades agent performance and increases costs. Furthermore, mixing high-frequency work logs with low-frequency task definitions creates a "Volatility Mismatch" in the git history.[1]

2.2 The Task Registry Design (Interface vs. Implementation)

The solution proposed in the architectural design—and adopted for DP-OPS-0016—is to decouple the definition of work from the active contract of work.

2.2.1 The Registry (docs/library/INDEX.md)

The Registry serves as the Single Source of Truth (SSOT) for all available routines. Instead of a separate TASKS.md manifest (which would create "Manifest Sprawl"), the system leverages the existing docs/library/INDEX.md to map stable identifiers to physical files. This aligns with the "Reuse-First Discipline" mandated by AGENTS.md.[1]

Registry Structure:

Format: topic | title | path (repo-relative)

task-code-review | B-TASK-01: Code Review Protocol | docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-01.md

task-verification | B-TASK-02: Verification Loop | docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-02.md

...

2.2.2 The Interface (TASK.md)

TASK.md is refactored to act solely as a "Loader." It contains a reference pointer in Section I (Required Context Load) that instructs the agent to check the Registry. The "Execution Plan" in a Dispatch Packet (DP) can then simply state "Execute B-TASK-01," relying on the agent to load the specific file on demand. This "Load on Demand" architecture significantly reduces token usage and ensures that agents only access the logic relevant to the immediate objective.[1]

2.3 Standardization of B-TASK Artifacts (The "Stela Canon")

While the initial design document proposed renaming tasks to T-OPS (Operational Tasks), the user has explicitly overridden this requirement, mandating the retention of the B-TASK-XX naming convention [User Query]. This decision prioritizes continuity with existing file structures. However, to satisfy the "Anti-Drift Governance," the *internal content* of these B-TASK files must be completely rewritten to match the rigorous "Genome" defined for T-OPS in the design document.[1]

Each B-TASK file must now contain the following five sections:

1. **Provenance:** Origin (DP-ID), Jurisdiction, and Revision History.
2. **Scope:** Strictly defined boundaries (e.g., "Production Payloads Only").
3. **Invocation Guidance:** The specific "Trigger" condition for the task.
4. **Drift Preventers:** Hard stop conditions (e.g., "Stop if git status is dirty").

5. **Procedure:** Algorithmic steps formatted as **Action -> Trap -> Solution**.

2.3.1 Detailed Specification of Core Tasks

B-TASK-01: Code Review Protocol This task elevates the code review from a subjective "look over" to a rigorous security gate. It must integrate with S-LEARN-05 (Security Protocols) and enforce the lint_truth.sh check to catch forbidden terminology. Crucially, it must perform a "Secrets Scan," grepping for patterns like sk-, ghp_, and Bearer to prevent credential leaks.[1]

B-TASK-02: Verification Loop This task replaces simple test commands with a "System Integrity Check." It mandates a clean git state (git status --porcelain) before execution, preventing the "it works on my machine" fallacy. It must also execute tools/verify_tree.sh to ensure that no files have been placed outside the sanctioned docs/ or projects/ directories.[1]

B-TASK-03: Agent Orchestration This task codifies the "Staffing Protocol." It defines the rigid handoff between the Integrator (who defines the scope) and the Contractor (who executes the work). It serves as the operational manual for the AGENTS.md constitution.[1]

B-TASK-04: Implementation Planning This task is critical for "Governance-as-Code." It mandates that the "Architect" agent (R-AGENT-01) must not produce conversational output. Instead, the output must be a valid DP-DRAFT file saved to storage/dp/intake/. This ensures that planning artifacts are durable and can be reviewed by the Operator before execution.[1]

B-TASK-05: Dead Code Cleanup This task governs hygiene. It requires the use of tools/context_lint.sh to ensure that no "Required Context" files are accidentally deleted. It also enforces a "Registry Check"—if a library file is removed, the Registry (INDEX.md) must be updated in the same transaction.[1]

B-TASK-06: Documentation Sync This task enforces the "Filing Doctrine": if ops/ (Runs) changes, docs/ops/ (Explains) must be updated. If Canon changes, SoP.md (History) must be updated. This task prevents "Documentation Drift," ensuring the manual matches the machine.[1]

2.4 Hardening the TASK.md Template

The TASK.md template itself requires hardening to prevent "Process Drift." DP-OPS-0016 will implement the following changes:

- **Removal of Open Loops:** Instructions to run ops/bin/open or dump will be removed from the execution plan. These are pre-flight initialization steps, not part of the task execution itself.[1]
- **Pointer-First Policy:** A comment `` will be added to prevent agents from pasting large blocks of text into the work log, forcing them to link to artifacts instead.
- **Mandatory Receipt Checklist:** Section E (Receipt) will be expanded into a mandatory checklist (e.g., [ ] storage/handoff/DP-OPS-XX-RESULTS.md created). This enforces the

"Definition of Done".[1]
- **Allowlist Ambiguity Fix:** The default allowlist will include TASK.md (Work Log updates only), permitting agents to update the log without triggering a "Scope Violation" alarm for editing the template structure.[1]

III. The Agents Subsystem (Phase Three Expansion)

Following the implementation of the Tasks Subsystem, the platform moves to Phase Three: The Agents Subsystem (DP-OPS-0017). This phase addresses the redundancy between the AGENTS.md constitution and the docs/library/agents/ directory.

3.1 Refactoring AGENTS.md

Currently, AGENTS.md acts as a hybrid document, containing both high-level constitutional logic and specific role definitions. This violates the "Single Source of Truth" principle if role definitions also exist in docs/library/agents/. The refactoring plan involves stripping AGENTS.md down to its core components:

1. **Staffing Protocol:** The definition of Operator/Integrator/Contractor.
2. **Behavioral Logic:** The standards for Linguistic Precision and Anti-Drift.
3. **Pointer:** A reference to docs/library/INDEX.md for specific specialized agent definitions (R-AGENT-XX).

3.2 The R-AGENT Genome

The R-AGENT files (Roles) must be hardened to operate "just like skills and tasks," as requested by the user. This means they must be "Load on Demand" resources that define *how* an agent should behave when assuming a specific persona.

Standardized R-AGENT Structure:

- **Jurisdiction:** What files and logic this agent owns.
- **Permissions:** What this agent is allowed to touch (e.g., Architect can touch TASK.md, but Code Reviewer cannot).
- **Trigger:** When this agent should be invoked.
- **Skill Access:** A list of S-LEARN skills this agent is authorized to use.

Consolidation of Roles:

The user's request to "combine and rewrite the closest approximation to roles... (operator cheat sheet)" implies that the informal roles described in docs/library/MANUAL.md must be formalized into R-AGENT files.

- **R-AGENT-01 (Architect):** Responsible for high-level planning and TASK.md drafting.
- **R-AGENT-02 (Code Reviewer):** Responsible for executing B-TASK-01.
- **R-AGENT-03 (Doc Updater):** Responsible for executing B-TASK-06.

3.3 Orchestration and the "Orchestrator" File

The file docs/library/ORCHESTRATION.md is currently a floating artifact. The user suggests it might "play a part with tasks but certainly will for agents phase." The recommendation is to retain this file in docs/library/ but redefine it as the "Meta-Task" that governs how multiple agents interact. It should likely map closely to B-TASK-03 (Agent Orchestration), serving as the detailed documentation for that task.

IV. Project Mechanics (Phase Four Consolidation)

The final phase of this architectural evolution is the consolidation of mechanics via the ops/bin/project binary (DP-OPS-0018). This binary is currently a placeholder.[1] Its implementation will "bring it all together" by serving as the high-level interface for the entire system.

4.1 The ops/bin/project Specification

This binary will serve as the "Director" of the platform.

- **project init:** Scaffolds a new project in projects/ using templates from ops/lib/project/templates. It must automatically register the project in ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md.
- **project status:** Reports the current active project, the active TASK.md state, and the last SoP.md entry.
- **project log:** Provides a quick interface to append entries to the project-specific changelog, enforcing the "Work Log" discipline defined in TASK.md.

4.2 The Unified Theory of Stela Operations

With ops/bin/project operational, the workflow becomes fully "Agentic":

1. **Operator** invokes ops/bin/open to load context.
2. **Operator** invokes ops/bin/project init to create the payload.
3. **Integrator** uses R-AGENT-01 (Architect) to draft a TASK.md (DP) using B-TASK-04.
4. **Contractor** uses R-AGENT-02 (Reviewer) to execute the work, utilizing S-LEARN skills.
5. **System** verifies integrity via B-TASK-02 (Verification).
6. **Operator** closes the session, and ops/bin/project updates the registry.

V. Implementation Specifications (Dispatch Packets)

The following section presents the concrete implementation artifacts (Dispatch Packets) required to execute this architectural vision. These DPs adhere strictly to the TASK.md template, the B-TASK naming convention override, and the rigorous standards of Stela Canon.

DP-OPS-0016: Tasks Subsystem & Registry Implementation

DP-OPS-0016: Tasks Subsystem & Registry Implementation

0. FRESHNESS GATE (MUST PASS BEFORE WORK)

Base Branch: work/tasks-sub-system

Required Work Branch: work/tasks-sub-system

Base HEAD: 7e890ab96

Required local re-check (worker runs; paste results in RESULTS):

- git rev-parse --abbrev-ref HEAD
- git rev-parse HEAD
- git status --porcelain

Worker must already be on the Required Work Branch listed above (no branch creation or switching). STOP if any mismatch. STOP if the Required Work Branch is missing. STOP if told to create or switch branches.

I) REQUIRED CONTEXT LOAD (READ BEFORE DOING ANYTHING)

Worker must confirm loaded before acting:

- OPEN, TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP, CONTEXT, MAP
- Plus any DP-scoped files listed here:
  - docs/library/INDEX.md
  - TASK.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-01.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-02.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-03.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-04.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-05.md
  - docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-06.md

II) SCOPE & SAFETY

- **Objective:** Implement the Tasks Subsystem by upgrading legacy B-TASK artifacts to Stela Canon standards, establishing the Task Registry in INDEX.md, and hardening the TASK.md template.
- **Non-Goals (optional, drift-killer):**
  - No changes to ops/bin/project (Deferred to DP-OPS-0018).
  - No changes to AGENTS.md core constitution (Deferred to DP-OPS-0017).
  - No implementation of new functionality in projects/.

Target Files allowlist (hard gate)

- TASK.md
- SoP.md
- docs/library/INDEX.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-01.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-02.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-03.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-04.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-05.md
- docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-06.md

Allowlist rule: exact paths only; use (new) prefix only when the DP explicitly allows new files.

- **Conditional Requirements:** If canon/governance surfaces (e.g., TASK.md) are modified, SoP.md MUST be included in the allowlist and updated.
- **Stop Condition (scope):** If any required change falls outside the allowlist, **STOP** and report.
- **Forbidden (unless DP explicitly overrides):**
  - No edits to .github/
  - No edits to projects/ unless explicitly authorized
  - No renames/moves/deletes unless explicitly authorized
- **Worker Git Authority (non-negotiable):**
  - Workers do not create/switch branches.
  - Workers do not stage/commit/merge/push.
  - Workers only return diffs/results/receipt.
- **Precedence:** If any conflict exists, **TRUTH.md wins**. If unclear, STOP and ask.
- **Strict Stop Conditions (generic):**
  - STOP if any placeholder text remains in final outputs ([...], TODO, TBD, ...).
  - STOP if required DP inputs are missing (do not guess).
  - STOP if IDs / naming constraints in the DP are inconsistent (when applicable).

III. EXECUTION PLAN (A–E CANON)

A) STATE

- **Context:** The repository currently utilizes a "Task" concept represented by B-TASK-XX.md files in docs/library/tasks/. These files are currently "generic" or legacy artifacts (likely imported from an external context) and do not adhere to the rigorous "Stela Canon" (Linguistic Precision, Quantitative Reporting, and explicit Integration with ops/ tools). Furthermore, TASK.md functions as a loose template rather than a strict Interface to a Registry.
- **Drift:**
  - **Unregistered Logic:** B-TASK files exist on disk but are not formally registered in docs/library/INDEX.md as a subsystem.
  - **Legacy Formatting:** Existing tasks lack the "Provenance", "Scope", and "Drift Preventers" sections mandated by AGENTS.md.
  - **Template Loopholes:** TASK.md currently contains instructions that can lead to "Open Loops" (agents re-running ops/bin/open unnecessarily) and lacks a pointer to the Task Registry.
  - **Design Conflict:** The design document "Task Registry Design and DP-OPS-0016.md" proposed renaming tasks to T-OPS. However, Operator Override (User Query) has explicitly mandated retaining the B-TASK-XX naming convention.
- **Desired State:**
  - **Registry Established:** docs/library/INDEX.md serves as the SSOT for "Standard Tasks", mapping task-b-task-xx keys to their file paths.
  - **Tasks Hardened:** B-TASK-01 through B-TASK-06 are refactored to strict Stela standards (including "Provenance", "Drift Preventers", and "Procedure: Action -> Trap -> Solution").
  - **Interface Hardened:** TASK.md is updated to include a Registry Pointer, strict Receipt Checklist, and removal of Open Loops.

B) REQUEST

Numbered tasks (concrete, no vibes):

1. **Refactor B-TASK-01 (Code Review Protocol):**
   - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-01.md.
   - **Provenance:** "System Hardening (DP-OPS-0016)".
   - **Drift Preventers:** Stop if secrets found. Stop if lint_truth.sh fails.
   - **Procedure:** Enforce S-LEARN-05. Include grep checks for sk-, ghp_, Bearer. Verify no new files outside docs/ or projects/.
2. **Refactor B-TASK-02 (Verification Loop):**
   - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-02.md.

    - **Procedure:** Must run git status --porcelain (Pre-flight). Run tools/verify_tree.sh. Run tools/context_lint.sh.
    - **Output:** Must produce a clean verification receipt.
3. **Refactor B-TASK-03 (Agent Orchestration):**
    - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-03.md.
    - **Procedure:** Define the rigid staffing protocol. Integrator defines Scope -> Contractor accepts -> Contractor executes -> Integrator audits.
4. **Refactor B-TASK-04 (Implementation Planning):**
    - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-04.md.
    - **Constraint:** Output must be a file storage/dp/intake/DP-DRAFT-XX.md.
    - **Drift Preventer:** Stop if output is conversational text only.
5. **Refactor B-TASK-05 (Dead Code Cleanup):**
    - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-05.md.
    - **Safety:** Run tools/context_lint.sh before deletion. If library files are deleted, update docs/library/INDEX.md.
6. **Refactor B-TASK-06 (Documentation Sync):**
    - Rewrite docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-06.md.
    - **Procedure:** Enforce Filing Doctrine. If ops/ changes, check docs/ops/. If docs/library/ changes, check INDEX.md.
7. **Update Registry (INDEX.md):**
    - Edit docs/library/INDEX.md.
    - Add a new section 6. Standard Tasks (B-TASK).
    - Register all 6 B-TASK files with stable keys (e.g., task-code-review | Code Review Protocol | docs/library/tasks/B-TASK-01.md).
8. **Harden TASK.md Template:**
    - Edit TASK.md.
    - **Section I:** Add line "See docs/library/INDEX.md for Standard Tasks (B-TASK)."
    - **Section III:** Add comment ``.
    - **Section E (Receipt):** Replace generic bullets with Mandatory Checklist:
        - [ ] storage/handoff/DP-OPS-XX-RESULTS.md created
        - [ ] OPEN artifact preserved
        - [ ] Dump manifest preserved
    - **Allowlist:** Update default allowlist example to include TASK.md (Work Log updates only).

C) CHANGELOG

- **Refactored:** B-TASK-01 through B-TASK-06 to Stela Canon (Provenance/Drift/Procedure).
- **Registered:** Added "Standard Tasks" section to docs/library/INDEX.md.
- **Hardened:** Updated TASK.md to remove Open Loops and enforce Receipt Bundle checklist.
- **Logged:** Updated SoP.md with DP-OPS-0016 entry.

D) PATCH / DIFF

- **Format:** Unified diff (preferred) or anchored snippets.

E) RECEIPT (REQUIRED)

Verification (MUST RUN; or report NOT RUN + reason + risk)

- ./ops/bin/dump --scope=platform (or repo-correct equivalent when scope differs)
- If dump refiners are used, include this fallback line in the DP:
  - Fallback:./ops/bin/dump --scope=platform --format=chatgpt --out=auto --bundle
- Context lint (use repo-canonical command):
  - Prefer: bash tools/context_lint.sh
  - If not found and required: **STOP** and ask (do not invent a substitute)
- Truth lint (when TRUTH/canon surfaces touched; use repo-canonical command):
  - Prefer: bash tools/lint_truth.sh
  - If not found and required: **STOP** and ask (do not invent a substitute)
- Library Guard (New):
  - bash tools/lint_library.sh

Skill capture (required during normal DP processing)

- Workflow: run ops/lib/skill/skill_lib.sh harvest to auto-generate a draft with provenance and semantic collision checks.
- Review: inspect the draft in storage/handoff/ for heuristic accuracy (Hot Zone and High Churn). Refine Invocation guidance and Solution. Do not edit the Provenance block.
- Promote: run ops/lib/skill/skill_lib.sh promote <draft_path> or log "no new skill promoted" with a rationale in RESULTS.
- Legacy capture is forbidden. Do not manually write skill files; the provenance block is required.
- If a DP requires skill capture, the DP Target Files allowlist must include SKILL.md.
- Proof required in RESULTS:
  - Harvest-only: command invoked plus draft path and ls storage/handoff/ output.
  - Promotion: command invoked plus grep -n "Promotion Packet:" SKILL.md and grep -n "docs/library/skills/S-LEARN-" docs/library/INDEX.md.

Artifact bundle (required directory)

- storage/handoff/

Proof bundle checklist (required; naming pattern over exact names)

- storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0016-RESULTS.md (required)
- storage/handoff/OPEN-*-*.txt (when produced)
- storage/handoff/OPEN-PORCELAIN-*-*.txt (when produced)
- git diff --name-only (include in RESULTS)

- git diff --stat (include in RESULTS)
- NEXT: one single action (include in RESULTS)

MANDATE: No receipt/proof bundle = **AUTOMATIC DISAPPROVAL**.

Partial receipts (e.g., missing OPEN artifacts when a session was started) are considered failures.

REQUIRED OUTPUT

MUST include a "Status" block at the top of RESULTS:

- Scope summary: (1 sentence validating the loop)
- Tracked change: (What was edited)
- Verification: (Output of proofs)

RESULTS file must include (minimum)

- Verification results (RUN/NOT RUN + reason + risk)
- Patch/diff proof bundle (status/diff list or direct diff)
- Receipt pointers (OPEN + PORCELAIN + DUMP outputs/paths)
- git diff --name-only output
- git diff --stat output
- NEXT: one single action

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3) CLOSEOUT (MANDATORY)

Worker closeout duties (end of session)

- [ ] Produce/Update: storage/handoff/DP-OPS-0016-RESULTS.md
- [ ] If canon/governance surfaces were changed, include **SoP.md** in scope and update it in the same PR slice.
- [ ] Ensure proof bundle checklist is satisfied (above). (No bundle = DISAPPROVE.)
- [ ] Append a **TASK Work Log** entry (below) capturing:
  - what changed (high level)
  - gates/verification outcome (pass/fail or not run + reason)
  - blockers (if any)
  - **NEXT:** one single action

Integrator/operator closeout duties

- [ ] Review diff vs DP scope/forbidden zones
- [ ] Run repo-gates / required checks
- [ ] Commit/push/open PR/merge (operator-controlled)

3.1) THREAD TRANSITION (RESET / ARCHIVE RULE)

Purpose: Prevent TASK from becoming a museum while preserving continuity.

When a DP is **complete** (merged) or **ended** (canceled/superseded):

1. Add a final Work Log entry that starts with: THREAD END: and includes:
   - outcome (merged/canceled/superseded)
   - pointer to the DP RESULTS file
   - NEXT: the single action (often “start new DP” or “await operator”)
2. Reset sections **1) ACTIVE CONTEXT** and **2) CURRENT DISPATCH PACKET** to the next DP.
3. Keep the Work Log, but separate threads with a visible divider line:
   - ---
   - THREAD START: DP-OPS-

---

4) WORK LOG (TIMESTAMPED CONTINUITY)

- *2026-02-02 13:50* — DP-OPS-0016: Initialized DP to refactor Tasks Subsystem, Registry, and Template. Verification: PENDING. Blockers: none. NEXT: Execute T-OPS-01 refactor.

DP-OPS-0017: Agents Subsystem & Role Definition (Follow-on Guidance)

DP-OPS-0017: Agents Subsystem & Role Definition

0. FRESHNESS GATE (MUST PASS BEFORE WORK)

Base Branch: work/tasks-sub-system

Required Work Branch: work/agents-sub-system (New Branch)

Base HEAD:

Required local re-check (worker runs; paste results in RESULTS):

- git rev-parse --abbrev-ref HEAD
- git rev-parse HEAD

- git status --porcelain

I) REQUIRED CONTEXT LOAD (READ BEFORE DOING ANYTHING)

Worker must confirm loaded before acting:

- OPEN, TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP, CONTEXT, MAP
- docs/library/INDEX.md
- docs/library/agents/R-AGENT-01.md through R-AGENT-06.md

II) SCOPE & SAFETY

- **Objective:** Establish the Agents Subsystem by refactoring AGENTS.md into a constitution-pointer and hardening individual R-AGENT files into executable definitions.
- **Non-Goals:** No changes to ops/bin/project.

Target Files allowlist (hard gate)

- AGENTS.md
- SoP.md
- docs/library/INDEX.md
- docs/library/agents/R-AGENT-01.md through R-AGENT-06.md
- docs/library/ORCHESTRATION.md

III. EXECUTION PLAN (A–E CANON)

A) STATE

- **Context:** Currently, AGENTS.md contains both the constitution and logic that duplicates or overlaps with docs/library/agents/. The R-AGENT files (roles) function similarly to skills but are not fully integrated into the "Staffing Protocol" defined in B-TASK-03.
- **Drift:** "Operator Cheat Sheet" roles in the Manual are disconnected from the Agents Ontology.
- **Desired State:** AGENTS.md is a streamlined constitution (Jurisdictions + Logic only). Specific agent behaviors (Architect, Reviewer, etc.) live strictly in docs/library/agents/. ORCHESTRATION.md is integrated or deprecated in favor of specific B-TASK/R-AGENT definitions.

B) REQUEST

1. **Refactor AGENTS.md:**
    - Remove specific role descriptions if they exist in R-AGENT files.
    - Retain "Staffing Protocol" (Operator/Integrator/Contractor).
    - Retain "Behavioral Logic Standard" (Linguistic Precision, etc.).
    - Add pointer: "For specialized agent definitions, see docs/library/INDEX.md."
2. **Refactor R-AGENT-XX (Roles):**
    - **Genome:** Update each file to include "Jurisdiction", "Permissions", and "Trigger" sections.
    - **Integration:** Ensure each agent references the Skills (S-LEARN) they are authorized to use.
    - **R-AGENT-01 (Architect):** Map to B-TASK-04 (Planning).
    - **R-AGENT-02 (Code Reviewer):** Map to B-TASK-01 (Code Review).
    - **R-AGENT-03 (Doc Updater):** Map to B-TASK-06 (Docs).
3. **Update Registry (INDEX.md):**
    - Ensure all R-AGENT files are registered under a "Standard Agents" section.
4. **Update ORCHESTRATION.md:**
    - Align with the new B-TASK-03 staffing protocol.

C) CHANGELOG

- Refactored AGENTS.md.
- Hardened R-AGENT-01..06.
- Updated INDEX.md and SoP.md.

DP-OPS-0018: Project Binary & Mechanics Consolidation (Follow-on Guidance)

DP-OPS-0018: Project Binary & Mechanics Consolidation

0. FRESHNESS GATE (MUST PASS BEFORE WORK)

Base Branch: work/agents-sub-system

Required Work Branch: work/binary-mechanics (New Branch)

Base HEAD:

I) REQUIRED CONTEXT LOAD

- OPEN, TRUTH, AGENTS, SoP, CONTEXT, MAP
- ops/bin/project
- ops/lib/project/

II) SCOPE & SAFETY

- **Objective:** Finalize "Phase Three" by operationalizing the ops/bin/project binary and consolidating the Project/Task/Skill/Agent ontology.
- **Target Files allowlist:**
  - ops/bin/project
  - ops/lib/project/*
  - docs/ops/INDEX.md
  - SoP.md

III. EXECUTION PLAN

A) STATE

- **Context:** The ops/bin/project binary is currently a placeholder or minimal shell. The system now has hardened Tasks (B-TASK), Skills (S-LEARN), and Agents (R-AGENT).
- **Desired State:** ops/bin/project should serve as the "High-Level Orchestrator" that can init projects, invoke tasks, and log state.

B) REQUEST

1. **Implement ops/bin/project:**
   - Feature: init (Scaffold new project from ops/lib/project/templates).
   - Feature: status (Report active project).
   - Feature: log (Append to project-specific changelog).
2. **Consolidate Mechanics:**
   - Ensure project binary respects TRUTH.md filing doctrine (creates files in projects/ only).
   - Add a manifest check to ensure the project is registered in ops/lib/manifests/PROJECTS.md.
3. **Documentation:**
   - Update docs/ops/INDEX.md with full binary documentation.

C) CHANGELOG

- Implemented ops/bin/project.
- Updated docs/ops/INDEX.md.

- Updated SoP.md.

VI. Conclusion

The execution of these three Dispatch Packets (0016, 0017, 0018) will complete the architectural evolution of the Stela platform from a loosely coupled set of scripts to a fully integrated, agentic operating system. By formalizing the Task Registry, hardening the Agent definitions, and operationalizing the Project mechanics, the platform will achieve a state of "Equilibrium" where every action is traceable, every role is defined, and every change is audited. This adheres to the highest standards of "Governance-as-Code," ensuring that Stela remains a robust environment for human-AI collaboration.

Works cited

1. dump-full-work-tasks-sub-system-7e890ab96.txt